

SERN GENERAL ASSEMBLY 2026



SERN



**Trollhättans
Stad**

CITY OF TROLLHÄTTAN

28 – 29 MAY 2026

PROGRAMME

**ITALY AND SWEDEN
BUILDING EUROPE TOGETHER**

ARRIVAL DAY – WEDNESDAY 27 MAY



HEBE THEATER

19.30 - 22.30	Welcome to Trollhättan! Meet-and-greet event at the Hebe Theatre. Speech by Ulf Wadenbrandt or Jonas Torrestad, head of Folkets Hus. Aperitif: Light drinks and food will be served, followed by a music performance by the N3 Youth Symphony Orchestra.
---------------	---

DAY 1 – THURSDAY 28 MAY



LILLA NOVA ARENA

08.10	Participant meeting point at Scandic Swania Hall for bus transfer to the venue.
08.30	Registration of participants
09.00 - 09.30	Plenary opening of the SERN General Assembly 2026 • Saba Giovannacci, Chair of the SERN Executive Board • Angelika Lundgren Bielinski, Chair of the City Council at the City of Trollhättan • Michele Pala, Italian Ambassador to Sweden • Isabella Conti, Emilia - Romagna Regional Minister for Welfare, Third Sector, Childhood Policies and Education  INTERPRETATION ITA/SVE AVAILABLE  LILLA NOVA ARENA
09.30 - 09.45	Stronger Together: Advancing Digitalisation Through City Collaboration • Rasmus Ländström, Chief Digitalization officer, Trollhättan Municipality • Fredrik Carlsson, Chief Digitalization officer, Vänersborg Municipality • Jenny Broberg Kudryk, Digital strategist, Fyrbodal Kommunalförbund Moderator: <i>Fredrik Topplund, Municipality of Motala</i> LILLA NOVA ARENA
09.45 - 11.00	Parallel thematic seminars – free choice Seminar 1 - Ageing population, care and community wellbeing <i>The ageing population demands integrated responses spanning professional care competences, digital innovation, and urban design. This session will explore how digital tools and senior housing strategies can improve access, efficiency, and quality of care. The Solidarity Condominium model will showcase how urban regeneration can foster community wellbeing and reduce social isolation.</i> Speakers: • Competence development in elderly care <i>Gunilla Starräng, National Project manager Yrkesresan Äldre, Linköpings kommun R&D Östergötland</i> • Senior Housing: an urban regeneration strategy for community well-being <i>Daniela Tebasti, Mayor of Campogalliano, Unione delle Terre d'Argine</i> • Solidarity Condominium: an urban regeneration strategy for community well-being <i>Caterina Bagni, Mayor of Soliera, Unione delle Terre d'Argine</i> • Digital Solutions in Elderly Care: Improving Access, Efficiency and Quality <i>Josette Haddad, Development lead, Trollhättans Stad</i> Moderator: <i>Angelika Lundgren Bielinski, City of Trollhättan</i> TYCHO ROOM

	Seminar 2 - Urban regeneration KEPLER ROOM Urban regeneration goes beyond physical redevelopment, requiring strong social dimensions built on inclusion, participation, and community empowerment. This session will examine how young people can be actively involved in shaping public spaces, from participatory planning to youth engagement across Swedish municipalities. It will further illustrate how regeneration can address social inequalities and build more inclusive, resilient communities. Speakers: • Våra rum (Our Spaces) Experiences of Involving Young People in the Development of Places in three municipalities <i>Björn Ohlén, Culture strategist, Fyrbodol Association of Local Authorities</i> • Manzini OFF <i>Gabriele Agnetti, Strategic Planning and Performance Management Officer, Municipality of Parma</i> • Shaping Public Space: Citizen Participation in Spatial Planning in Southeastern Trollhättan <i>Sofia Hjort, Urban planner, City of Trollhättan</i> Moderator: <i>Saba Giovannacci, Province of Parma</i>
09.45 - 11.00	Seminar 3 - Digitalisation and inter-municipal collaboration among Trollhättan, Vänersborg and Fyrbodol BRAHE ROOM Digitalisation is a key enabler of inter-municipal collaboration, supporting more efficient, accessible, and data-driven public services. Sessions will cover a wide range of digital innovations, from automated building permits and food waste tracking apps to e-library services and smart road data systems. The transformative potential of digital co-creation in social work will also demonstrate how technology can drive organisational learning and innovation across territories. Speakers: • The Future of Reading: E Books, Library Services and Apps <i>Ann Dahlman, Head of Libraries, Vänersborg Municipality</i> • From Application to Approval: Automated Starting Clearance for Building Permits Using RPA <i>Kolbrá Ingólfssdóttir, System Administrator, City of Trollhättan – Urban Planning Dept.</i> • Smart Roads: Turning Road Data into Action <i>Christopher Holgersson, 3D Graphic Artist & Johan Åkesson, former Head of Street Maintenance, Vänersborg Municipality – Environment and building management Dept.</i> • Transforming Social Work Through Digital Co-Creation <i>Linnéa Nilsson, Coordinator, City of Trollhättan – Labour and Social policy Dept. & Niklas Bivald, Co-Founder, Allie.</i> • From Plate to Data: Tracking Food Waste with an App <i>Fredrik Carlsson, Chief Digitalization officer & Marianne Romi Operations Developer, Vänersborg Municipality</i> Moderator: <i>Fredrik Topplund, Motala Municipality</i>
11.00 - 11.30	Coffee break

	Scenario sessions - part I <i>Participants take part in structured working sessions, where they collaborate in small groups to analyse concrete challenges and develop practical solutions.</i> <i>Participants work in target groups and follow two parallel thematic tracks. Professional groups remain on the same theme, while political representatives rotate between the two themes over the two days. Participants attend according to their assigned target group.</i> TARGET 1: POLITICAL REPRESENTATIVES AT LOCAL & REGIONAL LEVEL Theme: Ageing Population: Integrated Approaches to Care and Community Wellbeing The aim of this session will be to support political representatives in exploring integrated, community-centred approaches to demographic ageing through structured, scenario-based group discussion. BRAHE ROOM TARGET 2: PROFESSIONALS IN WELFARE SERVICES Theme: Ageing Population: Integrated Approaches to Care and Community Wellbeing - part 1 The session aims to facilitate peer-to-peer learning through shared experiences: starting from a case study, participants discuss real implementation challenges from their own contexts across three themes (housing, technology, coordinated care) and develop recommendations based on what has actually worked or failed in practice. TYCHO ROOM TARGET 3: PROFESSIONALS IN URBAN REGENERATION Theme: Stakeholder Engagement Methods in Urban Regeneration Processes The aim of this session will be to identify methods for stakeholder engagement in Urban Regeneration processes. KEPLER ROOM
13.00 - 14.00	Lunch at NOVA
14.00 - 15.30	Study visits <i>Participants are invited to select one study visit during registration, according to their interests and availability. Places are limited and will be allocated based on capacity.</i> PTC (Production Technology Center) / WAAMLABZ AB. A leading hub for advanced manufacturing and 3D printing in the Innovatum area. It brings together companies, start-ups and research institutions to test and develop next-generation production technologies. WAAMLABZ AB, a spin-off from University West, specialises in additive manufacturing based on long-term research in welding and materials science. T-Engineering. An international engineering and technology company founded in 2011 by former SAAB employees. With strong roots in Trollhättan, it focuses mainly on the automotive sector, offering advanced expertise in product development, design and industrial solutions, with an emphasis on innovation and sustainability. Clinical Learning Centre (KLC) – University West. A specialised training facility where nursing and healthcare students practise clinical skills, communication and treatment through realistic simulations. The centre promotes reflective practice and equal care through innovative teaching methods. (Maximum capacity: 20 participants)

16.00 - 17.30	Executive Board Meeting (only for the members of the Ex. Board)	TYCHO ROOM  INTERPRETATION ITA/SVE AVAILABLE 
19.00	Guided bus tour around Trollhättan The meeting point for the guided bus tour of Trollhättan is the Scandic Swania hotel.	
19.30	<u>Dinner at NEVS Event Hall, Stallbacka</u>	

DAY 2 - FRIDAY 29 MAY

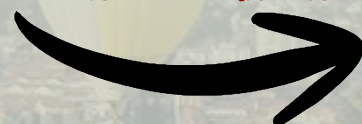


LILLA NOVA ARENA

09.00 - 11.00	Scenario sessions - part II <i>Participants continue the group work started on Day 1, focusing on the refinement of proposals, exchange of practices, and identification of concrete follow-up actions. Work continues according to the assigned target group and thematic track.</i> TARGET 1: POLITICAL REPRESENTATIVES AT LOCAL & REGIONAL LEVEL Theme: Urban Regeneration: Social Inclusion, Youth Participation & Community Empowerment The aim of this session will be to support local and regional political representatives in exploring how urban regeneration can be transformed from a primarily physical process into a genuinely social one through structured, scenario-based group discussion. KEPLER ROOM TARGET 2: PROFESSIONALS IN WELFARE SERVICES Theme: Ageing Population: Integrated Approaches to Care and Community Wellbeing - part 2 The session aims to build on Day 1 discussions by having participants share their experiences with community-led approaches, intergenerational programs, and sustainable funding models, collectively identifying strategies that enable programs to survive beyond initial project phases. BRAHE ROOM TARGET 3: PROFESSIONALS URBAN REGENERATION Theme: Navigating Challenges in Urban Regeneration Processes The aim of this session will be to understand challenges in the Urban Regeneration process and how to meet them. TYCHO ROOM	KOSHIBA ROOM Coordination meeting for SERN contact persons (only for designated contact persons)
11.00 - 11.30	Coffee break	
11.30 - 13.00	Parallel sessions Seminar on public procurement - Advancing Sustainable Public Procurement: Policies, Practice and AI <i>Public procurement is a strategic lever for municipalities to advance sustainability, social inclusion, and local development within existing regulatory frameworks. The session will explore how procurement processes can drive social and environmental sustainability goals, and how AI tools can support procurers in making smarter, more impactful decisions.</i> Speakers: • Working together makes Strategic Procurement work for your City <i>Rudie de Vries, Senior policy advisor sustainability, Haarlem Municipality</i> • AI as a useful assistant to the public buyer? Three applications <i>Fredo Schotanus, Professor of Public Procurement, Utrecht University School of Economics (U.S.E.)</i> • Sustainable public procurement in Italy: current instruments and possible developments. <i>Ugo Giudice, Contracting Authority Manager, Province of Parma</i> Moderator: Cecilia Burenby, Mjölby Municipality	TYCHO ROOM

11.30 - 13.00	Project Showcase <i>The Project Showcase is an interactive session where members will present ongoing or completed projects and local initiatives.</i> • Political and professional networks as part of the multi-level collaboration system <i>Titti Andersson, Assistant director, Fyrbodals kommunalförbund</i> • Food 4 Future - Engaging schools and families to combat food waste on rural municipalities <i>Norberto Vignali, Councillor on Environment and Education, Unione Pedemontana Parmense</i> • Transmic - VET Transforming micro-destinations through C-VET: enhancing governance, collaboration and sustainable growth <i>Johan Cavallini, Senior Consultant, Svensk Destinationsutveckling (SveDest)</i> • TIPS Project Trauma Informed Practice in Schools <i>Ginevra Roli, Project Officer, SERN</i> • DIGILIBRA Project: Digital Skills Empowerment in Libraries <i>Klara Wikman, Librarian, Motala Municipality</i> Moderator: Isak Johansson, Trollhättan Municipality BRAHE ROOM Meet the SERN Secretariat – space to discuss collaboration ideas and project proposals KOSHIBA ROOM
13.00 - 14.00	Lunch at NOVA
14.00 - 15.30	Joint study visit at Insikten Group will be divided into two. Historical storytelling by Henrik Olsson, historian and head of cultural heritages at Innovatum Science Center. Insikten is a creative meeting place in Trollhättan that brings together people, ideas and innovation. It offers an inspiring environment for collaboration, learning and future-oriented thinking. Insikten is part of the cultural and tourism area Trollhätte Canal Park, which also includes the iconic Trollhättan Locks and Trollhättan Falls. Coffee will be served during the study visit.
16.00 - 18.00	 INTERPRETATION ITA/SVE AVAILABLE SERN GENERAL ASSEMBLY LILLA NOVA ARENA
20.00	Dinner at <u>Albert Kitchen Hotel & Conference</u>

INFO ABOUT ORGANISATION



INTERPRETING SERVICE



INTERPRETATION
ITA/SVE
AVAILABLE

Interpretation (Italian/Swedish) will be provided during the following sessions:
Opening Plenary Session, General Assembly Session, and Executive Board session.
All other sessions will be in English.

The connection [link is available here on Zoom](#), and each participant will find the link in their individual program.

Please remember **to bring your headphones**, personal device and to download Zoom in advance before the event: [Zoom Download Center](#).

HOW THE PROGRAMME IS ORGANISED

The General Assembly combines plenary sessions, thematic work, study visits, and networking opportunities. Participants are invited to actively engage in the different formats.

Parallel Seminars

On Thursday morning, participants take part in parallel thematic seminars.

During registration, participants are asked to select one seminar among the available options:

- Ageing population, care and community wellbeing
- Urban regeneration
- Digitalisation and inter-municipal collaboration

Participation is subject to room capacity and will be confirmed by the Secretariat.

Scenario Sessions

Scenario Sessions are collaborative workshops organised by thematic track and target group. Participants work in structured groups to analyse concrete challenges, share experiences and practices, and develop practical solutions.

During registration, participants are invited to indicate their preferred thematic track:

- Ageing population, care and community wellbeing
- Urban regeneration

Political representatives follow both tracks over the two days.

SERN contact persons participate only in the first part of the Scenario Sessions.

For all other participants, the selected track applies to both days.

Final group composition is confirmed by the Secretariat before the event.

Project Showcase

The Project Showcase is an interactive session where members are invited to present ongoing or completed projects and local initiatives.

The session aims to encourage the exchange of experiences, the transfer of good practices, and the development of new partnerships within the network.

Members interested in presenting their projects are kindly invited to contact the SERN Secretariat in advance.

Meet the SERN Secretariat

“Meet the SERN Secretariat” is a dedicated space for informal dialogue and individual consultations with the SERN team.

Participants can use this session to:

- Discuss project ideas and proposals
- Explore possibilities for future cooperation within the network
- Clarify organisational or administrative questions

This session is open to all participants and is designed to support members in developing concrete initiatives and strengthening transnational collaboration.

Meeting SERN Contact Persons

The Meeting of SERN Contact Persons brings together the designated representatives of member organisations responsible for coordination and communication within the network.

The meeting provides an opportunity to:

- Share updates on ongoing activities and initiatives
- Discuss operational and organisational matters
- Coordinate future actions and priorities
- Strengthen internal communication and cooperation among members

This session supports the effective functioning of the network and facilitates alignment between the Secretariat and member organisations.

MAIN TOPICS OF THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY

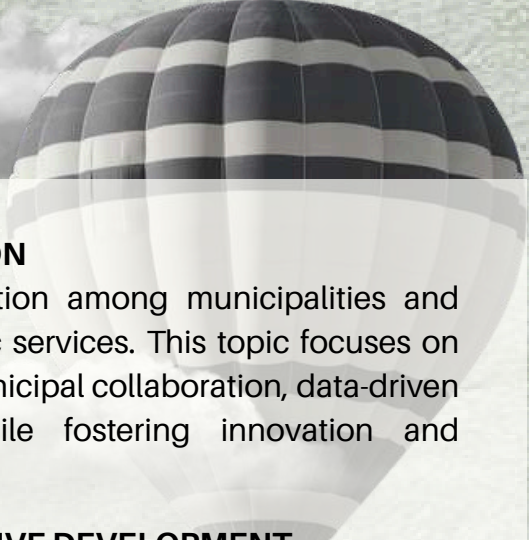
The SERN General Assembly 2026 focuses on some main thematic areas that reflect shared challenges and priorities among member organisations.

AGEING POPULATION, CARE AND COMMUNITY WELLBEING

The ageing population represents a long-term structural challenge that requires integrated approaches to care and community wellbeing, going beyond service provision alone. This topic invites members to reflect on how local communities can adapt public services, public spaces, and neighbourhood-based initiatives to promote active ageing, social inclusion, and intergenerational connections, while strengthening community-based care models that enhance quality of life and reduce social isolation among older people.

URBAN REGENERATION

Urban regeneration is a complex and long-term process that goes beyond physical redevelopment and requires a strong social dimension based on inclusion, participation, and community empowerment. This topic allows members to explore how regeneration policies and projects can actively involve young people, strengthen social cohesion in disadvantaged neighbourhoods, and give voice to residents, ensuring that regeneration processes address social inequalities and contribute to more inclusive, resilient, and liveable communities.



DIGITALISATION AND INTER-MUNICIPAL COLLABORATION

Digitalisation plays a key role in strengthening cooperation among municipalities and improving the efficiency, accessibility, and quality of public services. This topic focuses on how digital tools and shared platforms can support inter-municipal collaboration, data-driven decision-making, and integrated service delivery, while fostering innovation and organisational learning across territories.

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT FOR SUSTAINABLE AND INCLUSIVE DEVELOPMENT

Public procurement is a strategic lever for promoting sustainability, social inclusion, and local development within existing regulatory frameworks. This topic explores how municipalities can use procurement processes to support high-quality public services, encourage responsible supply chains, and facilitate the participation of small and medium-sized enterprises, while ensuring transparency, efficiency, and value for money.

